

IAS PRELIMS/MAINS

Ecology & Environment

A stylized illustration of a green city skyline with various skyscrapers, wind turbines, and a sun, set against a light green background with a globe-like shape.

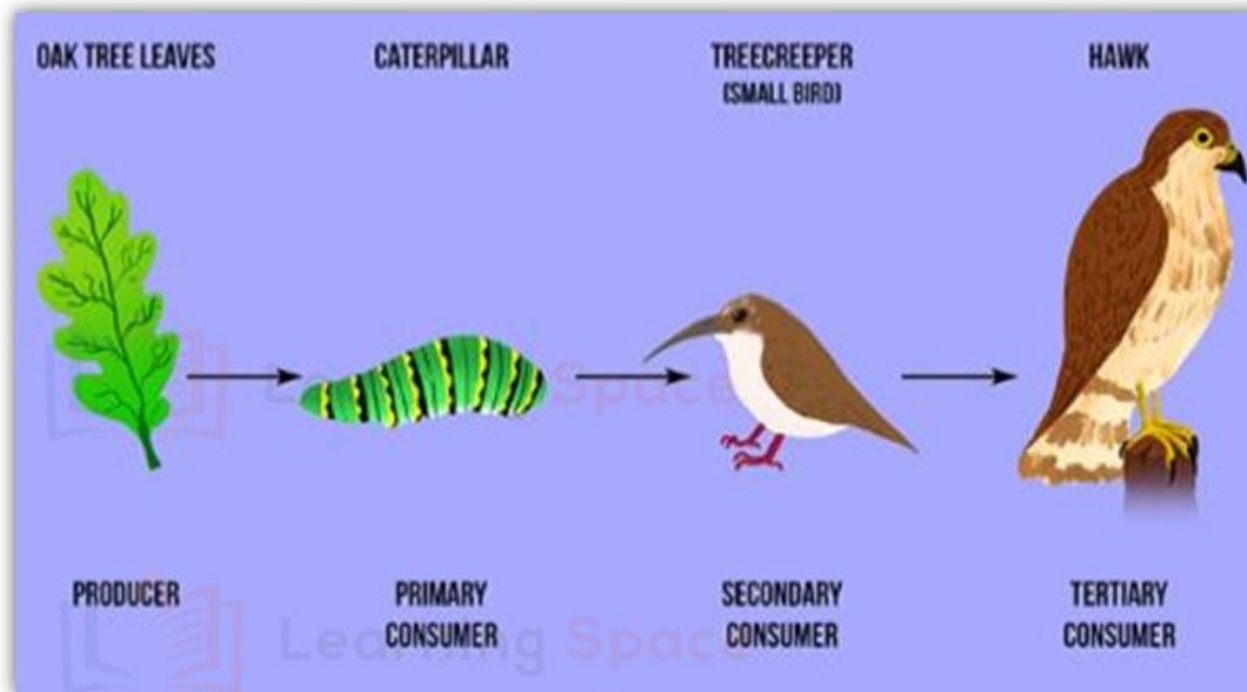
A COMPREHENSIVE COVERAGE

MODULE - 2

BASIC CONCEPTS - 2

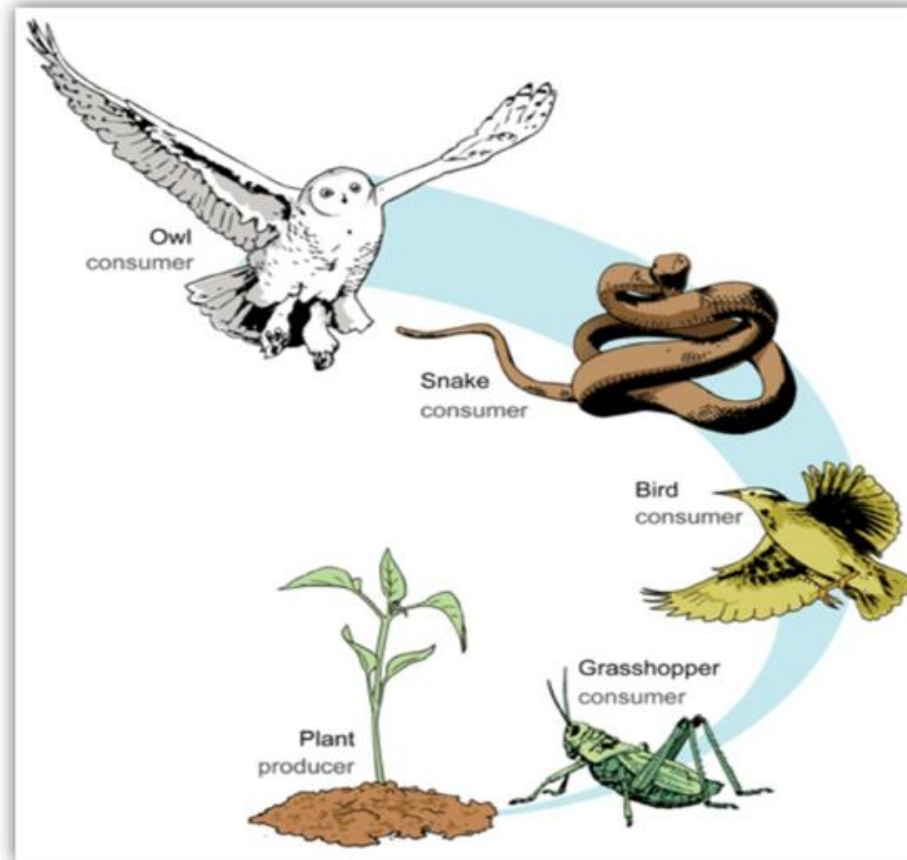
FOOD CHAIN

- A food chain acts as a link through which there is flow of energy from one organism to the other.
- A food chain starts with producers and ends with top carnivores.
- Each step in the food chain is called trophic level.
- The trophic level of an organism is the position it occupies in a food chain.



FOOD CHAIN

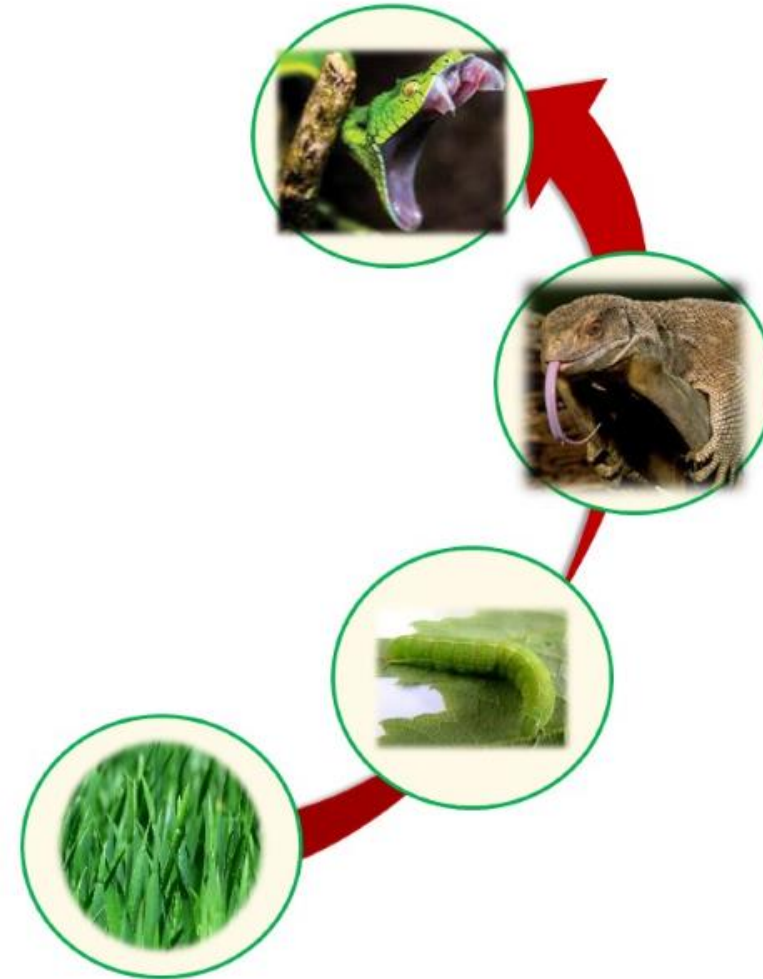
PLANTS
↓
GRASSHOPPER
↓
SMALL BIRD
↓
SNAKE
↓
OWL/EAGLE.



TYPES OF FOOD CHAINS

GRAZING FOOD CHAIN

- The consumers which start the food chain, utilizing plants as their food, constitute the grazing food chain.
- This food chain begins from green plants at the base and the primary consumer is herbivore.
- For example, in terrestrial ecosystem, grass is eaten by caterpillar, which is eaten by lizard and lizard is eaten by snake.
- In Aquatic ecosystem phytoplankton (primary producers) are eaten by zooplankton which are eaten by fish and fish are eaten by pelicans.



TYPES OF FOOD CHAINS

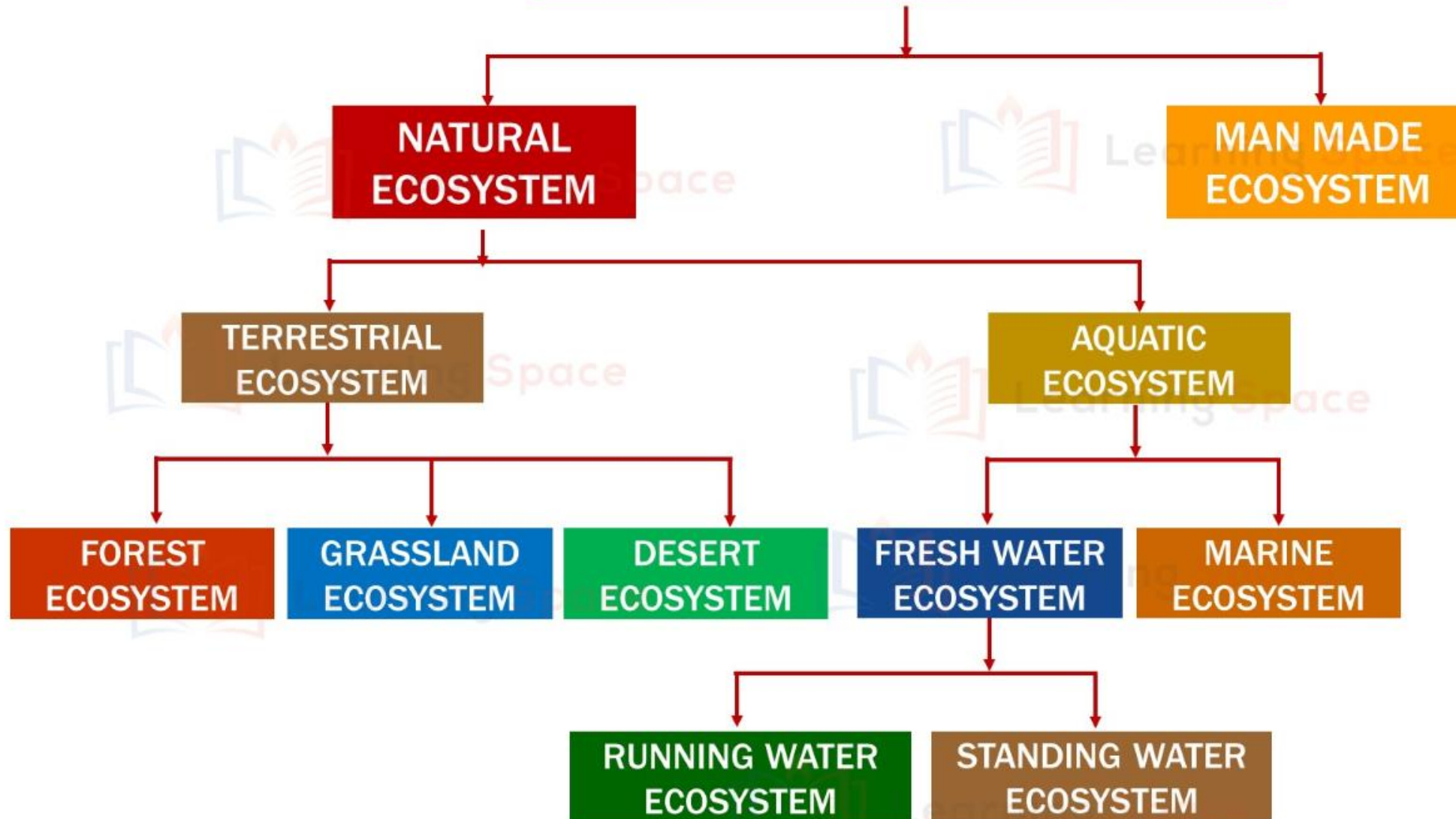
DETRITUS FOOD CHAIN

- This type of food chain starts from dead organic matter of decaying animals and plant bodies.
- Dead organic matter or detritus feeding organisms are called **detrivores**. The detrivores are eaten by predators.



The two food chains are linked. The initial energy source for detritus food chain is the waste materials and dead organic matter from the grazing food chain.

CLASSIFICATION OF ECO SYSTEM



WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0866 244 44 72

98499 42299

94415 27588